Decomposition in action

☞ **1** Put the steps below in the correct order to show how to make a compost heap.

- Water the heap to keep it moist.
- Collect manure, food scraps, leaves, soil, straw and shredded paper.
- Set aside an area for the heap.
- Cover the heap.
- Turn the heap once each week.
- Lay down manure, scraps, straw, soil, leaves and paper in layers.

1

2

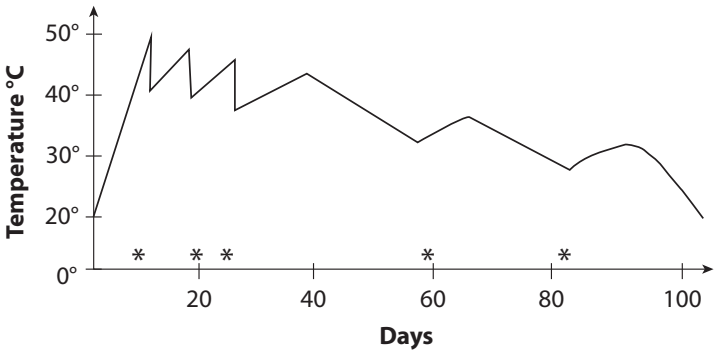
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Compost forms best if it is moist and has plenty of air. Very wet or very dry compost heaps break down slowly. The graph below shows the temperature in an uncovered compost heap.



* days when the heap was turned

☞ **2** Why does the temperature drop over time? _____

_____

3 What happens when the heap is turned? _____

_____

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